

The Four-Path Tech Tree

A **web**, not a **tree**: shared trunk, four branches (one per victory path), a cross-cutting war & espionage layer, and diagonal synergies for hybrids. A **capped research pool** + **escalating cross-branch cost** mean you can take roughly **one branch to its capstone** plus a **partial dip into a second** — which is exactly the dual-goal win. The tree is the victory structure.

★ **CAPSTONE** enables the HIGH goal · pick-limited

🛡️ **COUNTER** defense vs this path's spy

⚔️ **FORK** sidegrade — pick one, closes the other

⌘ **WAR** war-as-tool payoff feeding this path

SHARED TRUNK — EVERYONE STARTS HERE

The Keep
core · pop seed

Roads
logistics · research
pace

Market
→ Economic

Chapel
→ Religious

Scholar's Hut
→ Science

Farmstead
→ Domain

Muster & Spy Ring
→ war & espionage

Economic

HIGH · hold 1M · MED 500k

TIER I

Trade Post

Caravans generate steady gold flow.

TIER II

Guild Charter

Monopoly
one good, high margin

Bourse
diversified, resilient

TIER III

Banking House + Vault

Compound interest; Vault resists the Embezzler.

CAPSTONE

Grand Exchange

Hoard efficiency + income floor → sustain the 1M for the hold.

WAR TOOL

Religious

HIGH · 75%+2 · MED 50%+1

TIER I

Shrine

Preachers begin converting your populace.

TIER II

Holy Order

Missionaries
convert foreign land

Zealotry
faster home %

TIER III

Cathedral + Inquisition

Higher conversion; Inquisition resists re-conversion.

CAPSTONE

Grand Temple

Mass-conversion aura → 75% + 2 territories in reach.

WAR TOOL

Crusade

Privateers

Raids pillage enemy gold → straight into your hoard.

Seize a territory by force, then convert it.

Science

HIGH · tree+2 wonders · MED 1+75%

TIER I

Library

Raises base research speed.

TIER II

University

Engineering

faster wonders

Scholarship

faster tree

TIER III

Printing Press + Archives

Speeds tech; Sealed Archives resist the Saboteur.

CAPSTONE

Academy → Wonders

Unlocks the **science-exclusive** Wonders. #1 attainable, #2 gates the HIGH (escalating cost).

WAR TOOL

War Loot

Raid to fund wonders — or sabotage a rival's.

Domain

HIGH · 5000+5 · MED 2500+2

TIER I

Granary

Food variety → happiness → faster growth.

TIER II

Settlement Charter

Homesteads

raise capacity K

Colonists

settle faster

TIER III

Provincial Keeps + Festival

Medium keeps hold land; Festival Hall resists the Agitator.

CAPSTONE

Sovereign's Court

Sustains 5 territories + 5000 population under one crown.

WAR TOOL

Conquest

Annex enemy territory and its population — the warlord line.

DIAGONAL SYNERGIES — BRIDGES THAT MAKE HYBRIDS LEGAL (GREAT FOR YOUR MEDIUM GOAL)

Economic ↔ Domain

Trade Roads: a large population throughput pumps extra gold.

Domain ↔ Religious

Pilgrimage: temples draw immigrants — but unconverted, diluting your %.

Religious ↔ Science

Illuminated Manuscripts: faith and research boost each other.

Science ↔ Economic

Royal Mint: mechanization turns tech into treasury.

× CROSS-CUTTING WAR & ESPIONAGE — THE SHARED TOOL LAYER (ANY PATH)

Warcamp → Field Army

The shared military tool. It doesn't win on its own — it *feeds* each branch's × war-tool node above.



Bodyguard

The counter to the Assassin — protects your commanders

Spy Guild — offensive espionage

Each spy is the dedicated answer to one victory path (or, for the Assassin, to war itself):

Embezzler → Economic

Inquisitor → Religious

Saboteur → Science

Agitator → Domain

Assassin → war tool

during a hold.

Each branch's Tier-III  counter defends against its own spy — so being targeted is survivable if you paid the opportunity cost.

The five balance laws still hold: shared trunk, capped research, escalating cross-branch cost, sidegrade forks (not upgrades), and pick-limited capstones. Depth in one branch + a partial second = the dual-goal, expressed entirely in tech.